

Chicken Cacciatore with Crisp Polenta

This speedy take on an Italian slow braise is thick with tomatoes, onions, and mushrooms.

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<http://www.marthastewart.com/313309/chicken-cacciatore-with-crisp-polenta>

Prep Time	Total Time	Serves
20 minutes	40 minutes	4

Ingredients

- 3 tablespoons olive oil
- 8 skinless chicken thighs (about 3 pounds total)
- Coarse salt and ground pepper
- 10 ounces white mushrooms, trimmed and quartered
- 1/4 cup all-purpose flour
- 1 can (28 ounces) whole tomatoes in juice, broken up with a spoon
- 1 cup dry white wine, such as Sauvignon Blanc
- 2 medium onions, each cut into 8 wedges
- 4 garlic cloves, sliced
- 1/3 cup pitted green olives, halved
- 1 tube (16 ounces) plain prepared polenta, sliced into 12 rounds



PHOTOGRAPHY:

9.13.14

- do NOT use crushed tomatoes

Directions

1. In a 5-quart Dutch oven or heavy pot, heat 2 tablespoons oil over medium-high. Season chicken with salt and pepper. Working in two batches, sear chicken, meaty side down, until browned, 6 to 8 minutes; transfer to a plate (chicken will cook more in step 2).
2. Add mushrooms to pot; cook, stirring occasionally, until browned, 2 to 3 minutes. Add flour, and cook, stirring, 1 minute. Add tomatoes (with their juice), wine, onions, garlic, olives, and chicken (with any juices). Bring to a boil; reduce to a simmer, and cook until chicken is cooked through, 15 to 20 minutes. Season stew with salt and pepper.
3. While stew is cooking, heat broiler. On a rimmed baking sheet, brush both sides of polenta slices with remaining oil; season with salt and pepper. Broil, without turning, until deep golden brown, 10 to 15 minutes. Serve chicken cacciatore over polenta.